

FORGE Phase 1 • Week 6 • Session 17 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 17: De-escalation Techniques" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 17 as written runs about 105 minutes. This insert adds two short videos and one short talk, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 17A, "De-escalation"** (1 min 52 s). Today is about the heat at 7 or 8, shown on the heat scale; why de-escalation works, in the guide's words ("Logic doesn't reach a flooded brain"); and what today covers: body, voice, words, red lines and standing practice. It shows de-escalation calmly and never shows a fight. It ends on the recitation prompt and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 17B, "Tactical Empathy"** (1 min 49 s). The guide's cellie example with the three responses side by side, what the tactical-empathy response did, the five key phrases, and the redirect. It ends on "Validate first. Redirect second."
- **A short talk on the voice:** Julian Treasure, *How to speak so that people want to listen* (TED 2013, 9 minutes 44 seconds), with discussion questions.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 17A, "De-escalation"	2	Play it as soon as the men are seated.
0:02	Opening Circle: reciting the 5 steps	10	As written. No handbooks; the man next to someone who stumbles helps.
0:12	Instruction: De-escalation — Why It Works	5	The video gave the idea. Add the guide's amygdala explanation in your own words, then ask: "Has someone's calm ever brought you down? What did he do?"
0:17	Instruction: Body Language in De-escalation	15	As written, standing: stance, hands, distance, eye contact, face.
0:32	Talk: Julian Treasure, <i>How to speak so that people want to listen</i>	10	Seat the men. Introduce it in one sentence: "Listen for what he says about volume, pace and pitch. They're the three tools you're about to use to pace a man down."
0:42	Talk discussion	3	One or two of the questions below. The rest lead straight into Tone and Pace.
0:45	Instruction: Tone and Pace	10	As written, with both versions of the statement demonstrated.
0:55	Instruction: Tactical Empathy	15	

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
			Play Video 17B first. It covers the cellie example and the key phrases. Then work the guide's second example (the man disrespected in front of the dorm) and drill the phrases in pairs.
1:10	Instruction: The Redirect	10	The video introduced it. Teach it as written, with the redirect phrases and the warning not to redirect too early.
1:20	Instruction: Red Lines	10	As written. There is no video for this segment on purpose. Say it in your own voice, and leave time for "red line resistance" (see the Facilitator Notes).
1:30	Exercise: Standing De-escalation Practice	20	As written, three rounds. No touching.
1:50	Closing Circle	10	As written, with the homework: posture practice; journal on a time someone brought you down.

The session has no buffer. If the recitation round runs long, cut the talk discussion to one question and carry the others into the Tone and Pace segment.

Discussion questions for the Julian Treasure talk

1. He calls the voice an instrument and names its tools, including pace, pitch and volume. When a man is at a 7 or 8, what does each of those need to do? (*Volume lower, speed slower, pitch lower: pacing down.*)
2. He lists habits that make people stop listening, such as judging, complaining, excuses and dogmatism. Which of those would pour gasoline on a heated conversation in the dorm?
3. He talks about the power of silence. Where could a pause help you bring someone down, and when could it be read the wrong way?

Preview the talk before the session. It is a talk about everyday speaking and contains nothing graphic. Check it against the facility's rules for outside media.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *How to speak so that people want to listen* — **YouTube** (TED): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eIho2S0ZahI> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/julian_treasure_how_to_speak_so_that_people_want_to_listen

The same licensing note as Session 16 applies. TED allows a single talk in a single lesson, with credit. A talk that becomes a standing part of the curriculum may need TED's permission, and TED asks that talks not be scraped from its site. Ask TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, in-prison program.

Optional, a speaker with lived experience: Cobe Williams, *Interrupting Violence & Changing Mindsets*, TEDxSanJuanIsland 2017. Cobe Williams is a violence interrupter who has spent years de-escalating conflict in the streets, and he speaks about his own past. YouTube: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XYMy28CdLdA>. Its

length is not confirmed and it is not on TED.com. Preview it for length and for how it describes street violence before choosing it. It fits a make-up session or a later week better than this one, which has no spare time.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 17A and 17B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Talk loaded, previewed, and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ Chairs moved to the sides for the standing exercises